

James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

GTM Engineer who builds and operates enrichment, verification and outbound systems. For my own go-to-market business, MIA GTM, I run live outbound across four niches on a Python data pipeline with its own verifier and pre-send QA tool, and at FunnelEnvy I built the Clay outbound stack that lifted reply rates 27%. My work has contributed to \$10M+ in qualified pipeline, and I've traced silent deliverability failures, like sending domains activated without DNS records, before a campaign went out. More at <https://jamespraise.xyz/work/the-gtm-studio/>.

Selected Achievements:

- Built MIA GTM, a go-to-market system run as live outbound across four niches (B2B agencies, tech startups, plugin and app makers, Clay Solution Partners), with a niche portfolio system so each new segment gets its own brief instead of a one-off rebuild.
- Built a source-adaptor data engine across 10+ free-first sources with a self-built enrichment-and-verification layer and a standardized QA/preview tool, run live at production scale (409 Clutch agencies sourced, 271 verified emails enriched, 267 send-ready contacts).
- Led Reform's ESP migration from Userlist to Brevo, including full DKIM, DMARC, and SPF setup and a Kickbox list cleanup, hands-on CRM and email-infrastructure hygiene work.
- Built and ran the client acquisition engine for MIA Acquisition's US local-service clients, Outscraper sourcing, custom Python classification, multi-provider enrichment, and Smartlead delivery, at a ~94% enrichment hit rate on a 426-contact run, landing a signed client on a pay-per-qualified-lead model.
- Built an AI-enabled outbound GTM stack at FunnelEnvy using Clay, n8n, Claude Code, and Smartlead, improving outbound reply rates by 27% and lifting enterprise meeting bookings by 31% through a structured account-based marketing (ABM) playbook.

KEY SKILLS

GTM Strategy: Client-Facing GTM Engagement Delivery, Enrichment Waterfalls & Multi-Provider Data Routing, CRM Hygiene & Workflow Design, ICP Scoring & Segmentation, Agentic Workflow Architecture

Execution: Clay Table Design, Deliverability Diagnostics (SPF/DKIM/DMARC), Sequencer & Multi-Channel Campaign Management, AI Agent Setup, Outbound Personalization at Scale, A/B Testing

Tools: Clay, HubSpot, Salesforce, n8n, Smartlead, Instantly, Outscraper, Apify, Prospeo, [Apollo.io](https://www.apollo.io), MillionVerifier, Claude Code, GA4, Looker Studio

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder / GTM Architect | MIA GTM | 2026 – Present

Marketing In Action (Go-to-market engineering built and run live for funded B2B startups and agencies)

- Built a go-to-market system and ran it as live outbound for external prospects: Clay-driven enrichment, CRM workflows, and outbound sequences, run through a niche portfolio system where each niche (B2B agencies, tech startups, plugin and app makers, Clay Solution Partners) gets its own brief and reusable build.
- Built and operate the shared data engine underneath it: a source-adaptor architecture across 10+ free-first sources, a self-built email verifier, and a QA/preview tool that checks every send before it goes out.
- Landed real reply engagement through the Clay Solution Partners niche, including an engaged conversation with an agency managing director and a nurture conversation with a principal at a GTM engineering firm, proof the same system works as a genuine outbound motion, not just an enrichment pipeline.

Founder / GTM Engineer | MIA Acquisition | 2026 – Present

Marketing In Action (Client acquisition system for US local-service businesses)

- Built the same core engine for a different client base: Google Maps scraping, waterfall enrichment across multiple providers (~94% hit rate on a real 426-contact run), verified deliverability infrastructure, and a self-built QA tool that catches broken variables before send.
- Diagnosed and fixed a real deliverability failure via a pre-send DNS check: a provider had activated sending domains without ever publishing MX, SPF, DKIM, or DMARC records, a silent failure that would have killed a campaign with zero warning.

GTM Engineering Consultant | Marketing In Action | April 2024 – Present

Marketing In Action (Fractional GTM engineering for SaaS, B2B, and product-led companies)

- Designed and implemented AI-enabled revenue systems connecting positioning, enrichment, automation, and sales execution across client engagements.
- Cumulative impact across engagements: \$10M+ in qualified pipeline.

Growth, GTM & Demand Generation Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – April 2026

FunnelEnvy (B2B, Growth Marketing Service Provider)

- Designed and implemented an AI-enabled outbound GTM stack combining Clay, n8n, Claude Code, Smartlead, CRM workflows, and enrichment tools, improving outbound reply rates by 27%.
- Launched personalized outbound campaigns and a structured ABM playbook, lifting enterprise meeting bookings by 31%.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – April 2026

Reform (SaaS, MarTech)

- Led the ESP migration from Userlist to Brevo, including full DKIM, DMARC, and SPF setup, list cleanup with Kickbox, and n8n workflow validation, direct, hands-on CRM and deliverability engineering work beyond outbound cold email.
- Built AI-driven content and SEO systems using automated pipelines, scaling publishing velocity 30-100x.

Founder & Builder | Marketing In Action Newsletter | Apr 2024 – Present

Marketing In Action (Newsletter, Media & Community Platform)

- Designed and documented GTM automation workflows using Clay, n8n, Zapier, and AI agents.
- Open-sourced marketing agent skills on GitHub, covering GTM, lifecycle, and automation workflows.
- Grew the newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers with a 47% average open rate.

GTM Consultant | Hank Robotics | Aug 2025 – Nov 2025

Hank Robotics (B2B, AI-Powered Drone & Robotics Solutions Provider)

- Designed a 90-day inbound GTM engine combining SEO, paid acquisition, and CRM automation.
- Delivered +267% growth in search clicks and +1,900% qualified-lead growth within 3 months.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti (YC W23) | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024

Bujeti (SaaS, FinTech, Spend & Expense Management Platform)

- Built B2B lead generation systems combining inbound, outbound, and lifecycle automation for a fintech spend management platform.
- Generated 1,331 marketing qualified leads (MQLs) in 6 months and scaled B2B customers by 500%.

Demand Generation Manager | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023

Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B, Technology & Training Provider)

- Led revenue operations across Sub-Saharan Africa, generating 1,646 MQLs, 406 sales qualified leads (SQLs), and 629 demos booked, at 2-3x return on ad spend (ROAS) and customer acquisition cost (CAC) below \$0.50.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022

B2B, SaaS, Ecommerce, Agencies & Service Businesses

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification | Clay (2025)

